Topic: Citizens Face Delays in Government Service Approvals

Step:1

Key observations

- Citizens experience long waiting periods for certificates, licenses, and welfare approvals.
- Applicants frequently visit government offices for follow-ups.
- Online portals often face technical issues or slow processing.
- Lack of clear communication causes confusion and frustration.
- Delays result in dissatisfaction and stress among users.
- Citizens often need to make multiple office visits.
- Delays reduce public trust in government services.

Step :2

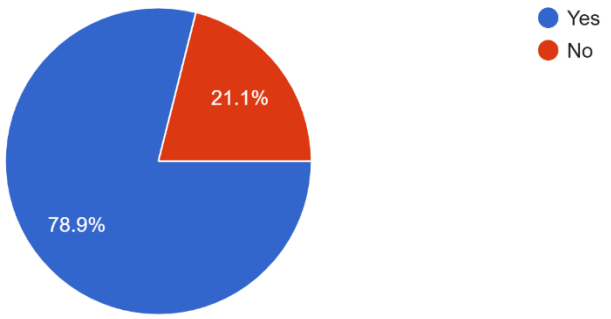
User Identification

- **Primary Users – Citizens / Applicants:** Apply for government services and expect quick approvals, clear timelines, transparency, and fewer office visits.
- **Secondary Users – Government Office Staff:** Verify documents and process applications; need proper staffing, training, and reliable digital systems.
- **Tertiary Users – Department Administrators / Supervisors:** Oversee service delivery and ensure deadlines; need accurate reports, accountability, and coordination between departments.

1. Have you ever applied for any government service?
2. Which type of government service did you apply for?
3. Did you face delays in getting approval?
4. How long did the approval take?
5. What do you think is the main reason for delays?
6. How satisfied are you with the government service approval process?
7. What improvement do you suggest?

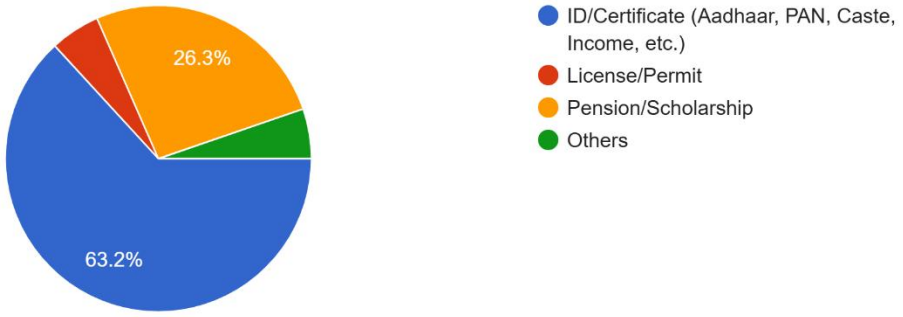
Have you ever applied for any government service?

38 responses



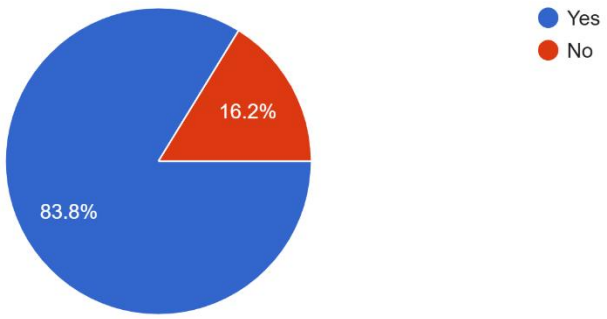
Which type of government service did you apply for?

38 responses



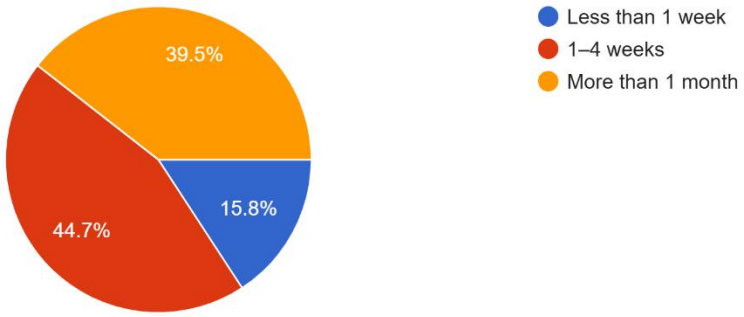
Did you face delays in getting approval?

37 responses



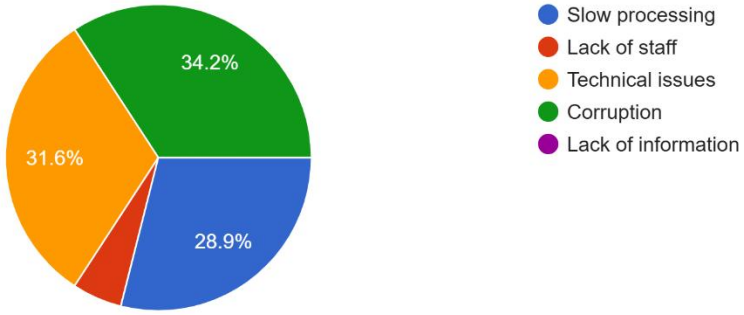
How long did the approval take?

38 responses



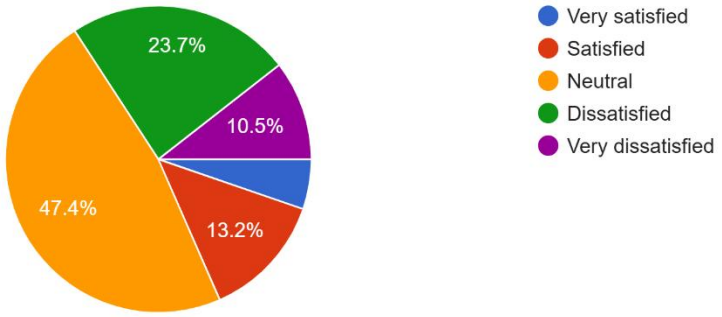
What do you think is the main reason for delays?

38 responses



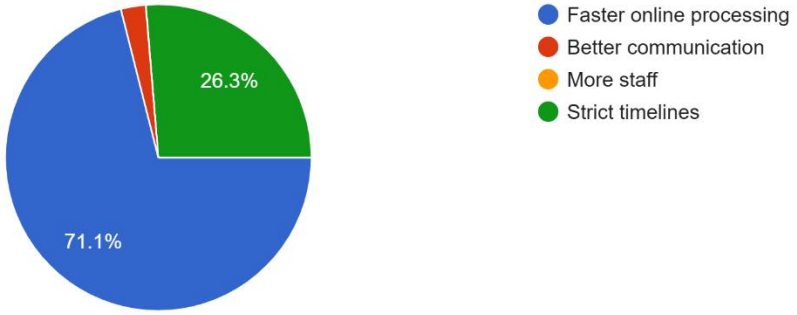
How satisfied are you with the government service approval process?

38 responses



What improvement do you suggest?

38 responses



Timestamp	Have you ever applied for any government service(	Which type of government service did you apply fc	Did you face delays in getting approval?	How long did the approval take?	What do you think is the main reason for delays?	How satisfied are you with the government servic	What improvement do you suggest?
1/23/2026 7:53:51	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Lack of staff	Dissatisfied	Better communication
1/23/2026 7:55:01	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)		Less than 1 week	Slow processing	Very satisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:00:20	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	More than 1 month	Corruption	Dissatisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:00:25	No	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	More than 1 month	Slow processing	Neutral	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:02:48	Yes	Pension/Scholarship	Yes	More than 1 month	Corruption	Satisfied	Strict timelines
1/23/2026 8:05:06	No	Pension/Scholarship	Yes	More than 1 month	Corruption	Neutral	Strict timelines
1/23/2026 8:05:26	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Corruption	Neutral	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:07:53	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	No	Less than 1 week	Technical issues	Satisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:08:01	Yes	Pension/Scholarship	Yes	More than 1 month	Corruption	Neutral	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:09:14	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	No	Less than 1 week	Technical issues	Very satisfied	Strict timelines
1/23/2026 8:10:37	No	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Technical issues	Neutral	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:12:19	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	No	1–4 weeks	Corruption	Neutral	Strict timelines
1/23/2026 8:12:46	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	No	Less than 1 week	Technical issues	Neutral	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:23:20	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	More than 1 month	Corruption	Dissatisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:35:31	No	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Technical issues	Satisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:40:08	Yes	Others	Yes	More than 1 month	Slow processing	Dissatisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:40:26	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	More than 1 month	Slow processing	Neutral	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:42:32	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Technical issues	Satisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:45:50	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Corruption	Very dissatisfied	Strict timelines
1/23/2026 8:47:47	Yes	Pension/Scholarship	Yes	More than 1 month	Slow processing	Dissatisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:51:54	Yes	License/Permit	No	1–4 weeks	Corruption	Neutral	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 8:59:51	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Corruption	Very dissatisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 9:00:55	Yes	License/Permit	Yes	More than 1 month	Corruption	Neutral	Strict timelines
1/23/2026 9:03:41	No	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Technical issues	Neutral	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 9:12:28	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	More than 1 month	Corruption	Dissatisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 9:13:16	No	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Technical issues	Neutral	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 9:20:28	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Technical issues	Dissatisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 9:24:14	Yes	Pension/Scholarship	Yes	More than 1 month	Slow processing	Very dissatisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 9:26:47	Yes	Pension/Scholarship	Yes	More than 1 month	Slow processing	Very dissatisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 9:34:05	Yes	Pension/Scholarship	Yes	Less than 1 week	Slow processing	Neutral	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 9:37:36	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Corruption	Neutral	Strict timelines
1/23/2026 10:01:23	Yes	Pension/Scholarship	Yes	More than 1 month	Slow processing	Dissatisfied	Strict timelines
1/23/2026 10:08:35	No	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	No	Less than 1 week	Lack of staff	Neutral	Strict timelines
1/23/2026 11:08:19	No	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Slow processing	Satisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 11:49:02	Yes	Pension/Scholarship	Yes	More than 1 month	Technical issues	Dissatisfied	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 13:29:11	Yes	ID/Certificate (Aadhaar, PAN, Caste, Income, etc.)	Yes	1–4 weeks	Slow processing	Neutral	Faster online processing
1/23/2026 15:59:55	Yes	Pension/Scholarship	Yes	1–4 weeks	Technical issues	Neutral	Faster online processing
1/26/2026 16:20:44	Yes	Others	Yes	1–4 weeks	Technical issues	Neutral	Strict timelines

Step :3

Key Insights from Interviews

- Majority faced delays of **1–4 weeks or more than a month**.
- Common reasons: corruption, slow processing, technical issues, lack of staff.
- Many respondents were dissatisfied with the approval process.
- Most suggested faster online processing and strict timelines.

Step:4

Pain- point Analysis

Category	Pain Points
Functional	Slow processing, repeated document verification
Emotional	Stress, frustration, loss of trust
Systemic	Corruption, poor digital infrastructure, lack of accountability

Critical Pain Point:

Unclear timelines and inefficient processing systems cause prolonged approval delays.

Step :5

Root Cause Identification

Problem: Long delays in government service approvals

1. Why are approvals delayed? → Because processing takes too long.
2. Why does processing take too long? → Due to manual work and technical issues.
3. Why is manual work still used? → Digital systems are unreliable or incomplete.
4. Why are digital systems unreliable? → Lack of proper maintenance and training.
5. Why is maintenance and training lacking? → Insufficient planning and accountability.

Step :6

Wicked Problem Understanding

This problem is classified as a **Wicked Problem** because:

- It involves multiple stakeholders (citizens, staff, administrators).
- Causes vary across regions and services.
- No single solution can fix all delays.
- Improving speed may affect verification and security.

Step :7

Reflection

1. What assumptions were incorrect?

- I assumed delays happen only because officers are careless, but I learned they are also caused by staff shortages, manual paperwork, and system issues.

2. How did user perspectives change your understanding?

- Understanding citizens' frustration and officials' workload helped me see the problem from both sides, not just from the public's view.

3. Why is jumping to solutions risky?

- Jumping to solutions without understanding the real causes can lead to ineffective systems that do not solve the actual problem.

4. What skills did you develop through this lab?

- I developed problem analysis, empathy, critical thinking, and user-centered thinking skills.

Conclusion

Delays in government service approvals are a serious public issue caused by systemic, technical, and administrative factors. Addressing these challenges requires better digital infrastructure, strict timelines, and improved accountability.

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